Neck Anatomy: Fascia & Triangles Overview (Set 1)
Master Sequence Followed

1. The platysma is a broad, thin subcutaneous muscular sheet located within the superficial fascia of the neck. It is motorically supplied by which branch of the facial nerve (CN VII)?
a. Cervical branch
b. Temporal branch
c. Marginal mandibular branch
d. Buccal branch
e. Posterior auricular branch
2. The deep cervical fascia is divided into multiple distinct layers. The outermost layer that completely encircles the neck like a collar, splitting to enclose the sternocleidomastoid and trapezius muscles, is the:
a. Investing layer
b. Pretracheal layer
c. Prevertebral layer
d. Carotid sheath
e. Buccopharyngeal fascia
3. Superiorly, the investing layer of deep cervical fascia splits to enclose which major salivary gland, forming its dense fibrous capsule?
a. Submandibular gland
b. Parotid gland
c. Sublingual gland
d. Thyroid gland
e. Von Ebner gland
4. The pretracheal fascia forms a specialized sheath in the anterior neck. It splits to enclose which endocrine organ and its associated muscles?
a. Submandibular gland
b. Thymus gland
c. Parathyroid glands only
d. Thyroid gland
e. Pituitary gland
5. Posteriorly, the pretracheal fascia continues superiorly over the external surface of the pharyngeal constrictor muscles, where it is formally renamed the:
a. Prevertebral fascia
b. Alar fascia
c. Pharyngobasilar fascia
d. Buccopharyngeal fascia
e. Sibson's fascia
6. The prevertebral fascia forms a tough, rigid osteofibrous floor over the prevertebral muscles. Superiorly, this fascial sheet fixes securely to the:
a. Zygomatic arch
b. Mandibular angle
c. Spine of the sphenoid
d. Clivus and external base of the occipital bone

e. Hyoid bone Greater horn

7. As the subclavian artery and the roots of the brachial plexus emerge from between the scalene muscles, they pull a lateral extension of the prevertebral fascia into the axilla to form the:

a. Carotid sheath
b. Axillary sheath
c. Pretracheal sleeve
d. Mediastinal compartment
e. Sibson's fascia loop

8. The carotid sheath is a dense, multi-layered neurovascular condensation of deep cervical fascia. What are the three primary structural contents housed inside this sheath throughout the neck?

a. External carotid artery, internal jugular vein, phrenic nerve
b. Common or internal carotid artery, internal jugular vein, vagus nerve (CN X)
c. Subclavian artery, subclavian vein, sympathetic trunk
d. Internal carotid artery, external jugular vein, ansa cervicalis
e. Common carotid artery, anterior jugular vein, recurrent laryngeal nerve

9. The dynamic muscle that serves as the primary structural divider separating the lateral aspect of the neck into an anterior triangle and a posterior triangle is the:

a. Trapezius muscle
b. Sternocleidomastoid muscle
c. Omohyoid muscle
d. Platysma sheet
e. Scalenus anterior

10. The sternocleidomastoid muscle takes structural origin via two distinct prongs. These prongs are the:

a. Sternal head (tendinous) and clavicular head (fleshy)
b. Mastoid head and occipital head
c. Hyoid head and scapular head
d. Mental spine attachment and genial head
e. Costal element and sternal slip

11. The sternocleidomastoid muscle runs obliquely upward and backward across the neck to insert onto the lateral surface of the:

a. Styloid process
b. External occipital protuberance
c. Zygomatic process
d. Mastoid process of the temporal bone and superior nuchal line
e. Angle of the mandible

12. Unilateral contraction of one sternocleidomastoid muscle draws the mastoid process downward, causing the face to rotate toward the:

a. Same identical side
b. Downward chest wall line
c. Back midline purely
d. Completely opposite side
e. Superior orbital margin

13. The sternocleidomastoid muscle receives its primary motor innervation from which cranial nerve?

a. Facial nerve (CN VII)

b. Glossopharyngeal nerve (CN IX)
c. Vagus nerve (CN X)
d. Spinal accessory nerve (CN XI)
e. Hypoglossal nerve (CN XII)

14. The posterior triangle of the neck is bounded anteriorly by the posterior border of the sternocleidomastoid and posteriorly by the anterior border of the:

a. Levator scapulae
b. Trapezius muscle
c. Splenius capitis
d. Omohyoid muscle
e. Scalenus medius

15. The lower boundary or base of the posterior triangle of the neck is formed entirely by the middle one-third of the:

a. Sternum bone
b. Hyoid bone body
c. Clavicle bone
d. First rib margin
e. Scapula spine

16. The inferior belly of the omohyoid muscle runs transversely across the lower segment of the posterior triangle, subdividing it into a large upper triangle and a small lower triangle. These are the:

a. Carotid and muscular triangles
b. Submental and submandibular triangles
c. Digastric and suprascapular spaces
d. Occipital and supraclavicular (subclavian) triangles
e. Omoclavicular and mental spaces

17. The roof of the posterior triangle is formed by the investing layer of deep cervical fascia. Which cutaneous nerve pops through this roof to ascend across the sternocleidomastoid to supply the skin over the parotid gland?

a. Lesser occipital nerve
b. Great auricular nerve
c. Transverse cervical nerve
d. Supraclavicular nerve
e. Greater occipital nerve

18. Winding downwards and backwards across the floor of the posterior triangle, embedded within the fascial roof layers, is a vital motor nerve trunk vulnerable to surgical laceration. This is the:

a. Phrenic nerve
b. Ansa cervicalis loops
c. Spinal accessory nerve (CN XI)
d. Long thoracic nerve
e. Dorsal scapular trunk

19. The floor of the posterior triangle is formed by a series of muscles covered tightly by the prevertebral fascia. From superior to inferior, these floor muscles are:

a. Sternohyoid, sternothyroid, thyrohyoid, omohyoid
b. Splenius capitis, levator scapulae, scalenus medius, and scalenus posterior
c. Digastric, mylohyoid, geniohyoid, stylohyoid
d. Platysma, masseter, buccinator, temporalis

e. Trapezius, masseter, longus colli, scalenus anterior

20. Emerging into the lower part of the posterior triangle (supraclavicular triangle) from between the scalenus anterior and scalenus medius muscles are the trunks of the:

a. Cervical plexus
b. Brachial plexus
c. Sympathetic chain
d. Ansa cervicalis
e. Intercostal nerves

21. The third part of which high-pressure artery crosses the floor of the supraclavicular triangle, where it can be clinically compressed against the first rib to arrest bleeding?

a. Subclavian artery
b. Common carotid artery
c. Axillary artery
d. Internal thoracic artery
e. Vertebral artery

22. The primary superficial venous channel that runs vertically down the lateral side of the neck, crossing the sternocleidomastoid muscle to pierce the investing fascia of the posterior triangle roof, is the:

a. Internal jugular vein
b. Anterior jugular vein
c. Retromandibular vein
d. External jugular vein
e. Common facial vein

23. The anterior triangle of the neck is bounded anteriorly by the anterior midline of the neck and posteriorly by the:

a. Anterior border of the trapezius
b. Posterior border of the sternocleidomastoid
c. Anterior border of the sternocleidomastoid muscle
d. Superior belly of the omohyoid
e. Posterior belly of the digastric

24. The superior boundary or base of the anterior triangle of the neck is defined macroscopically by the:

a. Upper border of the clavicle
b. Base of the mandible and a line connecting the angle of the jaw to the mastoid process
c. Body of the hyoid bone
d. Jugular notch of the sternum
e. Transverse process of the Atlas

22. The anterior triangle is split into four smaller spaces by the pathways of the digastric and omohyoid muscles. The only unpaired midline triangle among these four is the:

a. Submandibular (digastric) triangle
b. Carotid triangle
c. Muscular triangle
d. Submental triangle
e. Supraclavicular space

26. The submental triangle is bounded laterally by the right and left anterior bellies of the digastric muscle, and its floor is formed by the union of the two:
a. Geniohyoid muscles
b. Mylohyoid muscles
c. Hyoglossus muscles
d. Sternohyoid muscles
e. Platysma sheets
27. The submental triangle contains small, high-yield lymph nodes that collect drainage from the central parts of the face. These are the:
a. Submental lymph nodes
b. Submandibular lymph nodes
c. Deep cervical lymph nodes
d. Retropharyngeal lymph nodes
e. Preauricular lymph nodes
28. The submandibular (digastric) triangle is bounded anteroinferiorly by the anterior belly of the digastric and posteroinferiorly by the:
a. Superior belly of the omohyoid
b. Stylohyoid ligament purely
c. Posterior belly of the digastric muscle and the stylohyoid muscle
d. Anterior border of the sternocleidomastoid
e. Trapezius muscle edge
29. The most massive, prominent structural occupant packing the submandibular triangle is the:
a. Parotid salivary gland
b. Submandibular salivary gland
c. Sublingual salivary gland
d. Thyroid gland gland lobe
e. Palatine tonsil capsule
30. Winding deep to the submandibular salivary gland within the digastric triangle, before heading over the lower border of the mandible to reach the face, is the highly tortuous:
a. Maxillary artery
b. Lingual artery
c. Facial artery
d. Superficial temporal artery
e. Internal carotid artery
31. Running horizontally along the superficial surface of the hyoglossus muscle inside the submandibular triangle, supplying motor control to the tongue, is the:
a. Lingual nerve
b. Glossopharyngeal nerve (CN IX)
c. Mylohyoid nerve
d. Hypoglossal nerve (CN XII)
e. Vagus nerve branch
32. The carotid triangle is a vital vascular zone. It is bounded anterosuperiorly by the posterior belly of the digastric, anteroinferiorly by the superior belly of the omohyoid, and posteriorly by the:
a. Trapezius muscle
b. Anterior border of the sternocleidomastoid muscle

c. Posterior border of the sternocleidomastoid
d. Midline cervical raphe
e. Prevertebral muscle column

33. Inside the carotid triangle, the common carotid artery bifurcates into its terminal branches. This bifurcation normally occurs at the level of the upper border of the:

a. Hyoid bone
b. Cricoid cartilage
c. Thyroid cartilage (equivalent to C4 vertebra level)
d. Mandibular angle
e. Jugular notch

34. The localized dilatation situated at the commencement of the internal carotid artery that houses specialized baroreceptors to monitor blood pressure changes is the:

a. Carotid body
b. Carotid sinus
c. Jugular glomus
d. Aortic body
e. Mastoid node

35. Located immediately posterior to the carotid bifurcation is a small, reddish-brown structure containing chemoreceptors that monitor blood oxygen and carbon dioxide levels. This is the:

a. Carotid sinus
b. Thyroid gland isthmus
c. Parathyroid gland
d. Carotid body
e. Thymic node

36. The carotid body and carotid sinus receive their primary regulatory sensory innervation from which cranial nerve branch?

a. Facial nerve (CN VII)
b. Trigeminal nerve (V3 division)
c. Glossopharyngeal nerve (CN IX via the carotid sinus nerve of Hering)
d. Vagus nerve (CN X)
e. Hypoglossal nerve (CN XII)

37. The muscular triangle is bounded anteromedially by the anterior midline of the neck, posteroinferiorly by the sternocleidomastoid, and posterosuperiorly by the:

a. Posterior belly of the digastric
b. Superior belly of the omohyoid muscle
c. Inferior belly of the omohyoid
d. Stylohyoid muscle sheets
e. Thyrohyoid muscle margin

38. The muscular triangle contains a group of four strap-like muscles located superficial to the trachea and thyroid gland, collectively classified as the:

a. Suprahyoid muscles
b. Muscles of mastication
c. Infrahyoid muscles
d. Prevertebral muscle group
e. Scalene muscle pack

39. Which of the following is an infrahyoid strap muscle located within the boundaries of the muscular triangle?
a. Mylohyoid muscle
b. Sternohyoid (along with sternothyroid, thyrohyoid, and omohyoid)
c. Geniohyoid muscle
d. Stylohyoid muscle
e. Anterior belly of digastric
40. Embedded within the carotid sheath in the carotid triangle, running anterior or superficial to the carotid vessels, is a looping nerve path that supplies the infrahyoid muscles. This is the:
a. Phrenic nerve
b. Cervical sympathetic trunk
c. Ansa cervicalis
d. Recurrent laryngeal nerve
e. Long thoracic nerve
41. The superior root of the ansa cervicalis (descendens hypoglossi) is formed by fibers derived from the C1 spinal segment that hitchhike along which cranial nerve?
a. Glossopharyngeal nerve (CN IX)
b. Vagus nerve (CN X)
c. Hypoglossal nerve (CN XII)
d. Spinal accessory nerve (CN XI)
e. Facial nerve (CN VII)
42. The inferior root of the ansa cervicalis (descendens cervicalis) is formed by the fusion of ventral rami from which spinal nerves?
a. C1 and C2
b. C2 and C3
c. C3 and C4
d. C4 and C5
e. C5 and C6
43. All infraheard strap muscles are innervated by the ansa cervicalis loop, with one selective exception that is supplied directly by C1 fibers via the hypoglossal nerve. This exception is the:
a. Sternohyoid muscle
b. Sternothyroid muscle
c. Thyrohyoid muscle
d. Omohyoid muscle superior belly
e. Cricothyroid muscle
44. The large vascular channel that runs vertically through the carotid triangle, situated lateral to the common carotid artery inside the carotid sheath, is the:
a. External jugular vein
b. Internal jugular vein
c. Subclavian vein
d. Anterior jugular vein
e. Vertebral vein
45. The external carotid artery gives off eight major branches. The first branch that leaves the artery anteriorly within the carotid triangle to descend to the thyroid gland is the:
a. Lingual artery

b. Superior thyroid artery
c. Facial artery
d. Ascending pharyngeal artery
e. Occipital artery

46. The branch of the external carotid artery that arises inside the carotid triangle and runs deeply forward, medial to the hyoglossus muscle, to supply the core substance of the tongue is the:

a. Facial artery
b. Maxillary artery
c. Lingual artery
d. Superior thyroid artery
e. Descending palatine artery

47. The nerve that provides sensory innervation to the skin over the front and sides of the neck, crossing horizontally over the sternocleidomastoid, is the:

a. Great auricular nerve
b. Transverse cervical nerve (anterior cutaneous nerve of neck)
c. Lesser occipital nerve
d. Supraclavicular nerve trunks
e. Great occipital nerve

48. A clinician is setting up a local anesthesia regional ring block for neck surgery. The cutaneous nerves of the neck can all be targeted as they emerge behind the mid-posterior border of the sternocleidomastoid, a site known as the:

a. Pterion of the neck
b. Nerve point of the neck (Erb's point)
c. Carotid locus
d. Jugular confluence
e. Submental apex

49. The deep cervical fascia forms structural compartments. A potential space situated behind the pharynx and buccopharyngeal fascia, bounded posteriorly by the prevertebral fascia, is the:

a. Retro-nasal space
b. Retropharyngeal space
c. Carotid space
d. Suprasternal space of Burns
e. Submandibular compartment

50. The retropharyngeal space is of immense clinical significance because an abscess here can track downward unimpeded via gravity directly into the:

a. Oral cavity proper
b. Orbit cavity apex
c. Superior mediastinum of the thorax
d. Infratemporal fossa matrix
e. Sublingual salivary basin

51. The small, triangular space located in the upper part of the anterior triangle, bounded by the two anterior bellies of the digastric and the body of the hyoid bone, is the:

a. Carotid space
b. Submandibular basin
c. Submental triangle

d. Muscular channel
e. Supraclavicular recess

52. The floor of the submandibular triangle is formed primarily by two muscles. These are the:
a. Masseter and temporalis
b. Mylohyoid and hyoglossus muscles
c. Sternohyoid and sternothyroid
d. Digastric and stylohyoid
e. Trapezius and levator scapulae

53. Running immediately deep to the investing layer of fascia in the suprasternal space of Burns is a venous connection linking the two anterior jugular veins, known as the:
a. Pterygoid plexus
b. Jugular venous arch
c. Retromandibular confluence
d. External jugular trunk
e. Superior sagittal bridge

54. The alar fascia is a specialized subdivision of deep fascia that splits off from the prevertebral fascia to track across the midline, forming an accessory boundary within the:
a. Carotid sheath matrix
b. Retropharyngeal space (dividing it into true anterior and posterior zones)
c. Submandibular triangle floor
d. Muscular triangle ceiling
e. Suprasternal space

55. Lymphatic drainage from the submental lymph nodes tracks directly downwards and outwards to empty into the:
a. Submandibular lymph nodes and deep cervical chain
b. Occipital nodes exclusively
c. Retropharyngeal nodes
d. Mastoid nodes
e. Superficial parotid nodes

56. The sympathetic trunk in the neck is embedded within which structural connective tissue matrix?
a. Superficial layer of the skin
b. The posterior wall or deep layers of the carotid sheath fascia
c. Inside the lumen of the internal jugular vein
d. Deep to the mucosa of the hard palate
e. Within the substance of the parotid gland

57. If the cervical sympathetic trunk is compressed or damaged by a pathology in the neck (such as a lung apex tumor), the patient presents with Horner's syndrome. The classic clinical tetrad of Horner's syndrome consists of:
a. Facial paralysis, loss of taste, trismus, epiphora
b. Toothache, epistaxis, CSF rhinorrhea, macrostomia
c. Miosis (constricted pupil), partial ptosis (drooping eyelid), anhidrosis (loss of sweating), and enophthalmos
d. Hyperacusis, dry mouth, strabismus, exophthalmos
e. Complete blindness, paphedema, cataracts, glaucoma

58. The nerve that travels downward across the superficial surface of the scalenus anterior muscle, supplying motor control to the primary diaphragm muscle of respiration, is the:
a. Vagus nerve (CN X)
b. Phrenic nerve (derived from C3, C4, C5)
c. Sympathetic trunk
d. Long thoracic nerve
e. Ansa cervicalis
59. The branch of the vagus nerve that loops under the subclavian artery on the right side and the aortic arch on the left side to ascend in the tracheoesophageal groove to supply the larynx is the:
a. Superior laryngeal nerve
b. Internal laryngeal nerve
c. External laryngeal nerve
d. Recurrent laryngeal nerve
e. Pharyngeal sinus branch
60. Surgical approaches to the midline of the neck (such as during an emergency tracheostomy) are safely performed along the vertical line of connective tissue that joins the infrahyoid muscle blocks, which represents the:
a. Pterygomandibular raphe
b. Linea alba of the neck (midline cervical raphe)
c. Infratemporal crest line
d. Stylohoid ligament track
e. Mucogingival border

Answer Key Table (Fascia & Triangles - Set 1)

Q 1-8	Q 9-16	Q 17-24	Q 25-32	Q 33-40	Q 41-48	Q 49-56	Q 57-60

a	a	b	d	c	c	c	c
a	d	c	b	b	b	b	a
b	b	b	a	e	b	c	b
d	c	c	b	b	c	b	b
d	c	b	d	c	b	d	a
b	e	c	d	c	a	c	b
a	e	a	b	d	b	c	
b	d	a	b	d	b	c	